The Peninsular Courier

Published Every Friday,

Has a large circulation among Merchants, Mechanics, Manufacturers, Farmers, and Families generally.

DESIRABLE MEDIUM FOR ADVERTISERS.

R. A. BEAL, Publisher and Proprietor.

Terms: $1 50 a year in advance. $2 00 if payment is delayed. Single copies, five cents.

BOOK AND JOB PRINTING
OF EVERY DESCRIPTION,
CHEAPER THAN ANY OTHER HOUSE IN THE WEST.

Office—41 and 43 North Main Street.

The Peninsular Courier AND FAMILY VISITANT.

VOLUME XIII.—No. 18. ANN ARBOR, MICHIGAN, FRIDAY, MAY 1, 1874. WHOLE NUMBER 671.

The Peninsular Courier

Advertising Rates.

[illegible]

JOB PRINTING.

[illegible]

BOOK BINDING.

[illegible]

STATE AND COUNTY OFFICERS.

Members of Congress.

I. District—MOSES W. FIELD, of Wayne.
II. " —HENRY WALDRON, of Hillsdale.
III. " —GEORGE WILLARD, of Calhoun.
IV. " —JULIUS C. BURROWS, of Kalamazoo.
V. " —WILLIAM B. WILLIAMS, of Allegan.
VI. " —JOSIAH W. BEGOLE, of Genesee.
VII. " —O. D. CONGER, of St. Clair.
VIII. " —NATHAN B. BRADLEY, of Bay.
IX. " —JAY A. HUBBELL, of Houghton.

State Officers.

Governor—JOHN J. BAGLEY, of Wayne.
Lieutenant Governor—HENRY H. HOLT, of Muskegon.
Secretary of State—DANIEL STRIKER, of Barry.
Treasurer—VICTORY P. COLLIER, of Calhoun.
Auditor General—WILLIAM HUMPHREY, of Lenawee.
Attorney General—BYRON D. BALL, of Kent.
Commissioner of Land Office—LEVERETT A. CLAPP, of St. Joseph.
Superintendent of Public Instruction—DANIEL B. BRIGGS, of Genesee.
Member of Board of Education—EDWARD DORSCH, of Monroe.

Members of Legislature.

Senator—J. WEBSTER CHILDS.
Rep. First District—[illegible]
Rep. Second District—[illegible]
Rep. Third District—[illegible]

County Officers.

[illegible]

CITY CHURCH DIRECTORY.

Baptist Church.

Rev. S. Haskell, Pastor.
[illegible]

Catholic Church.

Rev. [illegible], Pastor.
[illegible]

Congregational Church.

Rev. [illegible], Pastor.
[illegible]

Episcopal Church.

Rev. [illegible], Rector.
[illegible]

Lutheran Church.

Rev. [illegible], Pastor.
[illegible]

Methodist Church.

Rev. [illegible], Pastor.
[illegible]

Presbyterian Church.

Rev. [illegible], Pastor.
[illegible]

Unitarian Church.

Rev. C. H. Brigham, Pastor.
[illegible]

BUSINESS CARDS.

D. F. ALLMENDINGER,
Organs, Melodeons,
Violins,
ACCORDEONS, &c., &c.
[illegible]

J. F. SCHAEBERLE,
Gives lessons on the
PIANO, VIOLIN AND GUITAR.
[illegible]

EDWARD D. KINNE,
ATTORNEY AT LAW.
Office removed from Court House to
Sloman's Block,
[illegible]
ANN ARBOR, MICHIGAN.

WILLIAM HERZ,
HOUSE, SIGN, ORNAMENTAL & FRESCO PAINTER.
[illegible]

F. SORG,
HOUSE, SIGN AND ORNAMENTAL PAINTING.
[illegible]

ANN ARBOR
MINERAL SPRINGS.
M. HALE, M. D.,
[illegible]

MRS. H. J. HILTON, M. D.
Physician and Surgeon.
[illegible]

GEORGE H. HOPKINS,
LAWYER.
[illegible]

N. [illegible]
Manufacturer of
CARRIAGES, BUGGIES, WAGONS and SLEIGHS
[illegible]

WILLIAM W. NICHOLS,
DENTIST!
[illegible]

HOPE IN ADVERSITY.

BY [illegible]

[illegible]

THE AYMERS.

CHAPTER XIII.

MR. AYMER WRITES—THE LETTER—TO CROUCH ISLAND AND "IN SWIMMIN'"—CAT SPRUCE GUM—KJOKKENMODDINGS, AND WHAT THEY YIELD—PHILIP RAMPANT.

Mr. Aymer's visit to New York not only resulted in the detention and arrest of the absconding Baron, but also in something tender and interesting, which cannot be told quite yet.

His return home was announced to his children by a letter.

"Dear Children," it began—for I don't count the date when, and the place where, anything.

"*Dear Children:*—I was very glad, on my arrival last night, to find your letters awaiting me."

He found just four.

"I was careful to open and read them in exactly the order in which they were written. The first gave me much concern, for it was evident from its tone that you were not favorably impressed by 'Bard as you call him. It was very thoughtful in you, my daughter, to inform me so promptly of the change in your feelings. I was very glad to know it, for, although I wish you to remain until the beginning of school in September, I should feel it my duty to bring you home at once if you could not like the person to whose care you were especially entrusted.

"Now I have something to say about the execution of your letters. You misspell too many words. Of course I do not expect you to know how to spell all the words you may wish to use, but a dictionary will always teach you, and when you don't feel perfectly certain about a word, look there for it, and when you have found it, make it yours so you will never need look again. At no time of life can you learn to spell more easily than now.

"And, my son, there is a fault in your manner of expressing yourself that I wish to correct. I have never noticed it in your verbal communications, but it stands out in your letters.

When you write of yourself and others together, you name yourself first. I once heard a man, in telling a story, express himself thus, 'The dog, and me, and father.' Now, your grammar is really no better than his, and your modesty suffers by comparison, for he put himself second, while you put yourself first. I have never forgotten two rules on this subject, that I learned in my own school days. I will give them to you, and the one exception, also.

1. When speaking of yourself in connection with those older, name yourself last. e. g. King, and Count, and I, went fishing. You know better than to use the objective case, me, for the nominative, I. Don't do it any more.

2. When speaking of yourself in connection with others of the same age, or younger, name yourself last—this time through courtesy. Courtesy is very becoming both sexes, and all ages.

There is a very strong temptation when a company of young people have performed some creditable act, for the narrator of the event to name himself first. Never do that, Philip. Modesty requires that the other thing should be done.

Now comes the exception.

If it should be your duty to confess to a participation with others in some unworthy act, then name yourself first. To do so is magnanimous, and magnanimity is very becoming, as well as courtesy.

I have addressed myself particularly to Philip, because his language particularly offended. But, my daughter, you will find what I have written worthy of your attention, also.

Your young friends are well. Johnnie French constantly wishes himself with you—which is a singular coincidence.

Present my kindest regards to the captain, Mrs. Adams, 'Bard, and the younger members of the family. And write to me just as generously as you have hitherto done. Your affectionate father,

A. AYMER."

This letter was received in the morning—and a warm, uncomfortable morning it was. After dinner the young people—they were all at leisure that day—gathered on the hill, in the shade of the great willow. The air was tremulous with heat. Sampson and the colt, and all the horned cattle, had fled for refuge from the hot air and the flies, into the compact growths of spruce in which the pasture abounded. Nothing, I think, but the fact that insects were swarming, kept the birds out. They looked as if they, also, wished to get into the shade, and let their tongues loll out of their mouths. But, as already said, insects swarmed—it was their weather—and birds must "make hay while the sun shines," as well as men.

King had been on an errand to the Banks in the morning, and finding the tide out of the thoroughfare on his return, he made her fast by the shore outside. From the willow tree they could just see the tops of her masts. A little swell came in from outside, where a fresh breeze was fighting its way in, and this rocked the boat about, and made the masts appear as if two great, awkward boys were trying to balance them on their chins.

Suddenly Count, who was lying flat on the grass, raised himself to a sitting posture and exclaimed,—

"Let's go over to Crouch Islan' an' go in swimmin'!"

Crouch Island was like a pair of tongs, with the legs spread a little. The "head" of it was in sight about two miles off, across the bay. The cove, or little bay, between the legs of land, was all bare at low water. The sun, when the tide was down at mid day, heated the mud very hot, so that the incoming water at flood tide was warmed in consequence. Count had described the place to Philip and expatiated on the joys of "goin' in swimmin'" there, until he had wrought him up to a fever pitch on the subject. He therefore eagerly seconded Count's motion.

"It's just the right kind of a day," Count added further.

"But what will Isabella do?" asked 'Bard, to whom the boys had appealed. "It won't do for her to go."

At once two pair of eyes were turned upon Isabella, in mute supplication. And not in vain.

"Never mind me," said the unselfish girl.

"There, she don't want to go!" cried Count.

"No, I didn't say that, Count," answered Isabella. "I should like to go, but because I can't, I won't keep you back. You go along, and I'll go with 'Bard to the store. I guess I'll have a good time."

That settled the matter, and the swimmers took their departure. Isabella went with them to the shore, and as they pushed off tossed stones into the water by the side of the boat, and splashed water on those inside. The boys might have retaliated with ballast rocks, but did not. Perhaps conscience whispered, "You deserve it, for deserting her."

Slowly the boat moved to her destination, rolling lazily with the swell, for the wind then blowing was too light to steady her much. But when they had reached the point that lay opposite them, and beat up between it and the island, the flood tide swept them on quite swiftly. The opposite shores between which they sailed, were little more than a stone's throw apart. On the right—the continental side—the bank rose up with considerable abruptness, even to quite a hight, and was thickly overgrown with spruces and firs. On the left—the insular side—the bank, six or seven feet high, was a sheer wall of whitish rock, then soil succeeded in which grew oaks and maples, and birches, that reached their branches far out over the water, and would have shaded it some had the sun ever taken the short cut across the northern quarter of the heavens, or even gone over in mid heaven. But he did not do either. Always at noon of the summer solstice, as well as at other times, he was far enough south to peep under.

Three quarters of a mile were quickly accomplished with the aid of the tide, and then they hauled their wind around the adjacent leg of the island. It was only about two hundred yards across, and when they had sailed that distance the cove, extending half a mile into the island, was visible. Its surface was unruffled by any wind, and they rolled their sails up and propelled the boat onward with the oars. The banks were fringed with alders, and were very low in many places. A buff colored heron, standing four feet in his bare toes, was wading about on the farther shore. And such a creature as he was! Two fifths of him were legs, and two more neck, and the other fifth—not more—body. He was fishing very industriously for minnows when discovered; but when he in turn discovered the new comers, he leaped into the air with a harsh, discordant note of alarm, and flew away with his long spars sticking straight out behind.

The boys put their hands over into the water as they moved up the cove. It was very warm. Down on the slimy, soft bottom they could see flounders and sculpins fleeing from the great, dark object that moved so mysteriously above them. The sculpins went quite deliberately, but the flounders drove headlong over the mud, raising a cloud as they went, like coaches driven over a dusty road.

By and by, when they about two-thirds of the distance up the cove, and at an equal distance from the two sides, they held water with their oars, and when the boat was still, King thrust the blade of an oar down into the soft mud, and secured the boat to it by her her painter. Then they threw off their clothing and leaped overboard. The water was only about six feet deep, and, as has already been said, very warm. If the boys had felt any twinges of conscience on account of Isabella, they did not feel any now, surely. Their shouts as they climbed into and leaped out of the boat [illegible] doubles of their mirth in the [illegible] of some ancient crows, that were observing from a group of tall firs, and shaking their wise heads as they [illegible] their doubts to each other in coarse croaks.

They—the boys—dove and brought up mud which they threw at each other; they crawled under the boat and rocked her by the keel, and swam races with splashing sufficient to terrify all the "ground sharks at Antigua."

Do you remember such scenes as in your boyhood, brother?—for I suppose men will sometimes glance over this narrative, in their leisure moments, to see what their children are reading. Not particularly when you swam, but when you played with a perfect abandon, whether in the water, or on the turf? Time may cover those scenes with layer after of pleasures, or care, or suffering, or crime, but there will be no oblivion of nature; and they will crop out. "'A babbled of green fields,'" did bohemian, drunken old John Falstaff, even, and that, too, when his extremities were "cold as stone."

'Bard, who could not swim, did not indulge in any of these antics, of course, but after remaining a short time in the water dressed himself again. King could not restrain himself entirely, but oscillated between manly dignity and boyish boisterousness.

By and by the cool sea breeze that had for hours been struggling with the dull, dead atmosphere, prevailed, and came sweeping over the head of the island.

"C'me ashore, now," said 'Bard.

The boys climbed in and put on their clothes with dispatch. Then 'Bard requested them to put him on shore there, and take him on board again at the lower end of the island when they had navigated the boat around. He had a commission to execute, from a rheumatic neighbor, who saw in a plaster of cat spruce gum, release from a few of the ills his flesh, bones, and nerves were heir to. I put it a little wrongly, perhaps, in saying that 'Bard was commissioned in this matter. It simply amounted to this. He knew his neighbor wanted such a plaster, and he knew that cat spruces grew on the island. Did not that knowledge, though, commission him?

"I guess we'll go, too, Philip," said Count, when 'Bard had spoken. "May be there're some raspberries yet among the alders."

Philip looked at King as if he thought that individual might have a word to say in the matter. He did; but it was—

"Oh, go—the whole of you. I can get round alone. I don't want any help."

So, while King made sail, 'Bard and Count paddled the boat to the shore, and the three who were to disembark, disembarked. King, having his sails hoisted and well [illegible] up, and his foresheet aft, shoved out an oar over the starboard quarter of the boat, and gave her stern a slue. The bow veered off shore and the foresail caught. Then he pulled in the oar, stuck the tiller in the notch-board hard a-port, and shoved his main boom off. The boat hung ahead for a moment, then whirled round on her heel. When she was fairly before the wind, King jibed the mainsail over, and her Snakeship, wing and wing, went flying out of the cove like a great bird.

Before this was accomplished the trio had disappeared in the alders, and 'Bard was near the head of the cove moving swiftly in the direction of the cat spruces at the end of the island.

Around the head of the cove the soil was water soaked and weed grown, but this soon gave way to a strip of fine pasture land, which swept up and formed a grass hillside. Or, it was the side of a headland, rather, for on the other sides the land sloped gently down to the water. The great willow, and the barn, at home, were visible from here, and on the descent in that direction was a growth of cat spruces, large and small ones mingled together. To these 'Bard went, and was as successful in collecting gum as he could desire to be. Professors of the art of "*directing*" had the year before practiced on the trunks of some of the trees, and where they slashed away the bark the pitch had run out and accumulated—just as, in the occasional warm days of winter, you have seen icicles pendant from the eaves of houses, grow.

'Bard soon had the envelopes of two old letters that he found in his pockets, filled with the anti-rheumatic-neuralgic, back-covering substance. And he could soon have filled all his pockets, also, if pockets were fit receptacles of pitch.

While thus employed he heard the voices of Count and Philip as they passed by him on their way to the place where King was to touch for them. This place was not far off, and he continued to hear them after they reached it.

Soon their louder tones and the greater rapidity with which they spoke, indicated some new source of excitement. As soon as his envelopes were full he moved through a little grove towards them, to see what interested them so much. When he was near enough to distinguish words, he heard Philip say—

"I ticked the middle one."

"Well," said Count, "now see me hit it."

Immediately there was the sound of some hard objects colliding, and then a burst from Count—

"There, what 'd I tell ye! See it go! Now, old fellow, if you had any hair on your head, I'd scalp ye!"

A light flashed upon 'Bard's mind. He darted through the smaller intervening trees, and appeared upon the scene. Just before him was Philip, with his right arm swung back, and a stone in the hand. Count was stooping over a little pile of stones at his feet. Eight or ten yards off, on a ledge, were three human skulls, two with their fleshless faces turned toward the boys, the other farther back, and in a reverse position.

"Stop!" roared 'Bard, when he saw all this—which, by the way, was just what he expected to see.

Philip lowered his arm.

"You young barbarians, what are you doing?"

"Oh," answered Count, "only heavin' a few rocks."

"But those skulls are not proper marks."

"I don't hurt them any."

You will easily see Count's drift. He was a very argumentative youth, and proceeded to defend the assault on the skulls on the ground that the sentient individual long ago removed to other scenes; this was only the roof of his deserted earthly habitation, and, of course, wholly without the sense of feeling.

Without making any answer, 'Bard walked to the ledge where the skulls were, and began to examine them. Taking up the one that Count's stone had knocked over, he pointed to the left temple, which had been broken in, and said to Count—

"You see you *did* hurt it."

"Oh, that didn't *hurt* any," he replied. The emphasis on *hurt* was sneering and defiant—as much as to say, "There is a 'difference betwixt tweedle dee and tweedle dum,' and *I* know what it is."

'Bard, however, gave him no chance to explode his charge, but continued his examination of the skulls in silence. They were very large, and in——

"No doubt they were large,"—this interruption will be from the critic—"no doubt of it whatever. The statement itself is large, suspiciously large. But how came they there? I never understood—nobody ever understood—that an island was necessarily a Golgotha."

The answer to this fierce interrogatory is simple and brief. The place where the boys stood was a Kjokkenmodding.

What's that?

I didn't suppose you would know, child. I used that word for the critic. I'll tell you why. It's for a barricade. He's after me, and I wish to arrest his pursuit a while. So I have dragged that long word, full of k's and diphthongs, across the path, and I think it'll be some time before he gets over it, or by the ends of it.

Entre nous—as the French say, meaning between us—Kjokkenmodding (pronounced Kirk-kew-mood-ing) is a Danish word, and means *kitchen refuse.*

Think of your own refuse heap at home, and you will have an idea of what is meant. Recall what has been added to it within your own recollection, a part of which you carried to it yourself, perhaps. I think I can venture to name the items of "fish, flesh, and fowl," oyster shells, and clam shells, and lobster shells, if you live on the shore; tin cans, old boots, shoes, and rubbers, maimed knives and forks, old mortar, broken bricks, shattered crockery ware, neckless bottles, perforated coffee pots, and, probably, a battered hoop-skirt.

That heap is your Kjokkenmodding.

In many places along the Atlantic shore the Kjokkenmoddings of the Indians are found—not fresh, of course, for it is a long time since the fires that cooked their clams, and fish, and venison, went out. Over them are layers of vegetable mould and earth, and even gravel, out of which great trees grow.

This one on which the boys stood cropped out at the edge of the bank; and as the frosts of winter and rains of summer disintegrated the mass, bones rolled out, and domestic implements, fashioned from bone and stone. These excited curiosity, and men dug in and were rewarded by finding more bones, human, and the bones of the lower animals, and more implements; and somebody—it was not known who—unearthed those skulls, and set them upon the ledge. This was only a little while before. 'Bard had not seen them, but he had heard of them, and that knowledge, coupled with the conversation of the boys, made him suspect what the marks were at which they were throwing stones.

A Kjokkenmodding!

Room now for the Ethnologist! Room for the Physiologist! Room for the Archæologist! Room for the Naturalist! Room for the Skeptic!

Why room for the Ethnologist?

To say to what race of men these skulls belonged.

Why room for the Physiologist?

To exhume from this shell-heap, and put in order, the kindred members of the skulls—the vertebræ that held them erect, the leg bones that gave them locomotion, the arm bones that put food into those jaws.

Why room for the Archæologist?

To stand by as the Physiologist digs, and pick up and label the implements of bone and stone that appear.

Why room for the Naturalist?

To name all these varieties of shells.

But why room for the Skeptic?

To air his skepticism, as he is always ready to do when the occasion is not half so favorable.

You don't see how this is a favorable occasion?

Why, there on that shell-heap—half an acre in extent, quite—the grass was very thick, and green, and sweet (to graminivorous animals). When you think of the great mass of fertilizing agents beneath the sward, you cannot wonder at that. And human bodies were in the mass, and from them many of the grass roots drew nutriment, and what had once walked the earth as men, now carpeted it as grass.

The whole island was a sheep pasture. This was the favorite grazing place of the sheep, and the grass—which was once man, remember that—became in the processes of nature sheep and lamb.

You have seen those wagons that have for bodies large cages, and straw on the bottom, sometimes.

Well, in such conveyances these island sheep were constantly making excursions to Thomaston, and were there slaughtered, and served up with green peas and new potatoes, and eaten by the inhabitants; and what had once been man, and then grass, and then sheep, or lamb, in the further processes of nature became man again.

You don't see anything for the skeptic in that?

Why, he will ask, "How will these bodies that were lain in the shell-heap get back in the resurrection their constituent parts, that nature in her economy has used in her economy has used in making other bodies that will also be raised?"

Oh, there is much for the skeptic here, and, believe me, he'll make much of it! Ingenious and enthusiastic man! it don't occur to him that there may possibly be something that he don't know.

You don't want to eat any Crouch Island sheep?

Oh dear, that thing isn't peculiar to Crouch Island! From the Egyptian mummy pits, ancient as the pyramids, and containing, perhaps, (who knows the contrary?) the embalmed first-born—from those pits vessels carry down to the Nile, femurs (thigh bones), tibiæ (shin bones), and other bony bits, to be shipped to England and ground into manure. The powder thus made is an excellent fertilizer—particularly for turnips. So it is extensively used in the production of that vegetable.

Turnips are mainly raised in England to fat the mutton breeds of sheep, Southdowns and Cheviots, for market.

You see, readily, what follows. Stated generally, it is exactly a parallel to the first case. See if it is not:

CASE 1.—Man; vegetable; mutton; man.

CASE 2.—Man; vegetable; mutton; man.

Exactly parallel cases, you see. But stated more specifically, they diverge. Thus—

CASE 1.—Indian; grass; native breed sheep; American.

CASE 2.—Egyptian; turnip; Southdown, or Cheviot; Englishman.

Quite diverse, you see.

[Conclusion of Chapter next week.]

FOREIGN CORRESPONDENCE.

Number LXXIV.

TAMSUI, FORMOSA, December 1st, 1873.

After an unsuccessful hunt after wild boars with some of the Tsuiwhan, we concluded to move on, and our departure was somewhat hastened by news arriving of the death of one of the sons of our host, when the whole household went into mourning, and Chinese mourning is too demonstrative to be pleasant to those near.

We sent word to the old chief, that we wished to go on, and would need men to carry our baggage, and the next morning eight or nine came to carry what three Chinese had brought in.

The Tsuiwhan have not yet learned to carry burdens like the Chinese, with a pole across the shoulder; but each had a little flat, wooden frame that was fastened upon the back, and upon this the load was secured. Each was armed with an old fire-lock, or with bow and arrows, and the old chief accompanied the party to attend to the pay, and to any little perquisites that fell to his office.

We left the old Chinaman, who had been so kind as to take us in, weeping for the loss of his son, and we could hear the loud wailing of the family long after we had left their roof.

Our escort were savage enough in appearance to please the most ardent lover of wild life. The chief's eldest son, bare-headed, and with long hair knotted together behind, clothed in buckskin shirt, which covered only the body down to the thighs, leaving legs and arms free, led the troop, while the rest, alike in clothing and arms, followed in Indian file, the old chief bringing up the rear, and, on account of his dignity, carrying only his fire-lock, and a huge Chinese umbrella belonging to Mr. Bullock, which he carried spread above his head in true savage style, though there was neither sun nor rain. He had received a gash in his thigh when a young man from a wild boar, which had apparently severed the muscle to the bone. This had healed without surgery, leaving a gap I could lay my hand in; but in spite of this and his eighty years of age, he still seemed as young as any of the lot.

As we were just leaving the little lake and valley of Tsuiria behind, and everything seemed progressing fairly, the savages suddenly dropped or crouched to the ground, and some began groaning, while others pounded with their great knives on the butts of their guns. When we inquired the meaning of this, we found that a bird famed for its foretelling powers had called out on the left hand side of the path, and this was considered an omen of evil. After a little stop they started on, but still groaning and beating their gun stocks. This bad omened bird stopped our march twice in the same way, but was then heard on the right hand, and we went on again.

We passed through a wooded country, there being much camphor, and pretty valleys shaded with wild plantains and tree ferns. By keeping in advance with my net I made quite a fine collection of rare woods butterflies and moths, as they rose up from the path and the bushes at the side.

We were shown one or two places where within a few years small parties of Chinese had been cut off by the Che-whan, who seem to be in the habit of watching some such wild path as this until some defenseless persons come along, when they dash out from their cover, cut off as many heads as they can, and hurriedly retreat to their villages in the mountains.

In the afternoon we broke out from this wooded, hilly country into a large plain known as Posia or Polisia. It is from five to seven miles in diameter, and contains over thirty villages, mostly of Sek-whan. A great share of it is under cultivation; but we could easily soon see that we were beyond the reach of the careful and thorough Chinese.

We soon came to a broad, shallow stream, which a dozen or so of women and boys were fishing after a novel but very successful process, which was to dam up and turn into a narrow channel the water of the stream, leaving most of the bed dry for a good distance, and then catching the small fish, shrimps, lobsters, etc., from the little holes and from beneath the stones. They all left their work as we came along, and came to the path to give us a good hand-shake, and to say *peng-an*—Chinese for *peace*,—a salutation they seemed to have learned from the missionaries, and it has become one of the peculiar institutions of these wild Christians. They seemed very hearty in their welcome, and likely never dreamed that there could be white men wearing beards, who were not missionaries, or at least good Christians and, therefore, brethren.

Following the stream down and crossing it several times, the water being cold and clear from the mountains, we climbed up a hundred feet, and found ourselves upon a plateau of a mile in diameter, too high for irrigation and cultivation, but with the village of Ogulan, and one or two others, built upon it. As we entered the straggling mud-built town of Ogulan, the whole of the people turned out to greet us, and our hands were shaken, and we were *peng-and* by every man, woman and child of the place. After the cold, suspicious treatment of the Chinese, who had often followed at our heels through their villages, shouting "*whan-a*,"—barbarian,—we were hardly prepared for such a greeting. We were led to the little chapel just being completed, where we found Mr. Campbell, and settled down for a two weeks' stay.

The chapel, built like two others in the valley mostly or entirely by the Sek-whan themselves, without help from the missionaries, was of adobes, with facings of stone and wood work of camphor, which only requires the cutting here. The floor was the earth, while it was seated with rough, camphor-wood benches, where twenty or thirty girls and boys were studying until our entry broke up the sitting. Upon one side a little mud-built, grass-covered building was occupied by the helper, who officiates as minister and school teacher, while upon the other was the *manse*, as Mr. Campbell called it, of the same construction, in which we took up our lodgings.

Our many visitors raised quite a dust from the earthen floor, and the two little windows of oiled paper were punched in many places by curious fingers; but, with these little drawbacks, I, at least, enjoyed my stay among this hospitable people.

Mr. Bullock had crippled his feet on the march in, and while we were waiting for them to get well, Mr. Campbell spent his time visiting the different stations in the valley, while I opened the cans of spirit I had brought with me, and soon had quite a lively market in fish, land and fresh water shells, snakes, turtles, and whatever else the people found of interest on their hunting and fishing excursions.

The results of the trip in serpents was nearly eighty, nearly all from this place. There were several poisonous species, among them a very pretty green one, and one day they brought a large one lassoed to the end of a long pole. They claimed that it was very poisonous, and as we approached to examine it, it flattened its neck and showed two spectacle-like spots that made me think of the descriptions I had read of the *cobra de capella*, and since my arrival here it has been examined by competent authorities, and proved to be one.

Whatever the hunters found of interest, they brought to me, and I had generally plenty to do without hunting myself. Nearly the first capture was a large, brown deer, with a fine set of antlers, that was shot by old Kisanhia, the elder of the church. The deer was brought in after night, the men lighting their way back by torches, and bringing it to the old shed before the chapel, where they set to work to skin it, the whole village standing around, and some of the old women and men thanking God for sending it to them. The little boys crowded around, and dipped up the blood in their hands, and drank it as if it were honey. After the deer came a fine, large monkey, and then two or three flying squirrels as large as cats, and then a magnificent pheasant of a rare species, and plenty of minor captures.

The little girls and boys contented themselves with bringing in beetles, crickets, grasshoppers and various other insects, and receiving their dole of cash, which they immediately laid out in sweets from the baskets of the Chinese peddler, who was ever close at hand.

The Sek-whan seem to have come from near Chung-wha originally, and there are still several settlements of them near that place. They claim to have migrated to Polisia some thirty years ago, fleeing from Chinese debts, and griping two days' journey into the wilderness among the savages. There has been likely a continual emigration since of distressed families, and they now number in this valley about four thousand. They are a finer and stronger race than the Chinese, and are without the inverted eyelids, except in cases where it can be accounted for by intermarriage. They also differ much from the Chinese in their large, wide mouths, and some of them were almost European in their features. They, without much doubt, represent a part of the aborigines who possessed the fine lands along the western side of the island; but having little of the economy and industry of the Chinese and their keenness at a bargain, they have gradually been driven back to the hills. They still have the savage love for hunting and fishing, and spend much of their time at it that would be better spent in their rice fields. They still speak their native language, which seems to be Malay in its derivation. With this the young people all speak, and many of them read Chinese; but many of the old people can understand but little of the language of their masters.

At the coming of the missionaries among them they had tablets and idols in their houses, after the Chinese custom, and they also had wild dances and singing of their own, and they seem to have had some sort of worship of a deer's head.

They received Christianity through Kisanhia, an elderly man, who was suffering from an ulcer, and strayed down to Taiwaufu, and got into the missionary hospital, where he was cured, and also learned something of the Gospel, and returned over a hundred miles to his people, threw his idols and tablets away, and began Christian worship with his family, were soon joined by his neighbors, and, before the missionaries heard of the movement, there were over a hundred that had destroyed their idols and were keeping the Sabbath—on Saturday—as the old man had lost his count on the way home.

The movement is but a little over a year old, and the missionaries have made the place but three or four visits; but there are now over two hundred church members, and likely six or eight hundred regular attendants of worship, and the only reason that the whole people do not embrace Christianity at once seems to be from lack of teaching from the missionaries. They are connected with the mission at Taiwaufu, which consists of one minister and a medical missionary. They have twelve stations, with as many young men, who undertake to teach and preach, and these are often almost as little learned in the Gospel as the people they undertake to teach, and there is no wonder that they are not very powerful agents of spreading the work already begun. They have Testaments and hymn books printed in the romanized colloquial, which is Chinese spelled out in Roman letters, instead of written in Chinese characters, and the little girls and boys have already learned to read and write it; but with only the Testament and hymn-book as text books, the work becomes very monotonous for both teachers and children.

This romanized colloquial is a good medium for the teaching of geography, arithmetic, and the other studies so common in our schools and unknown among the Chinese, but there are no text books translated yet. Every night and morning there was worship in the little chapel, a drum being beat to call the people together. A chapter was read, each reading a verse in turn, and many of the girls and boys too poor to have anything but a shirt to cover them, read fluently from their colloquial Testaments, while part of their elders read the Chinese character. After a prayer from one of the elders, there would be a hymn or two sung, sometimes to a tune taught by the missionaries, but more often to tunes of their own that had been used in idolatrous dances, and were now made to do duty in a better cause. Their own tunes were curious but very melodious, and our composers who are searching for something new might certainly find it here. Their voices are pleasing, and they have a real love of music and a readiness in learning it. I wished to learn some of their music, and called them in several times, a little girl of six or eight years of age, and badly marked with small pox, acting as chorister and raising the tunes. After they had sung for me I repaid by singing some Sunday school hymns from home, and before I came away they had learned three or four of these, and were singing them to their own hymns.

Our clothes, persons, books, baggage and all were objects of a great deal of respectful curiosity, and there was nearly always quite a cluster about to see us eat, wash, etc. One funny old fellow, who was always around to see what was going on, made up for what his pants lacked in length and thickness by always carrying, nights and mornings, a basket of burning charcoal, and squatted on his heels, with his basket between his bare knees, he formed a characteristic figure.

J. B. STEERE.

A Puzzled Dutchman.

A Wisconsin secular paper contains the following good story:

One who does not believe in immersion for baptism was holding a protracted meeting, and one night preached on the subject of baptism. In the course of his remarks he said, some believe it necessary to go down into the water, and come up out of it to be baptized. But this he claimed to be a fallacy, for the preposition "into" of the Scriptures, should be rendered differently, as it does not mean into at all times.

"Moses," he said, "we are told, went up into the mountain, and the Savior was taken into a high mountain, etc." Now we do not suppose that either went into the mountain, but upon it. So with going down into the water, it means simply going down close by or near to the water, and being baptized in the ordinary way, by sprinkling. He carried this idea out fully, and in due season and style closed his discourse, when an invitation was given to any one who felt so disposed to rise and express their ideas. Quite a number of the brethren arose and said that they were glad that they had been present on this occasion, that they were well pleased with the sound sermon they had just heard, and felt their souls greatly blessed. Finally a corpulent gentleman of Teutonic extraction, a stranger to all, arose and broke a silence, that was most painful, as follows:

"Mister Breacher, I ish so glad I vash here to-night, for I has had explained to my mint some dings I never could pelief pefore. We read, Mister Breacher, that Taniel was cast into the den of lions, and came out alife! Now I nefer could pelief dot, for de wild peasts would shust eat him up right off; put now it ish fery clear to my mint. He vas shust close py or near to, and tid not get into de den at all. O, I vas so glad I vas here to-night!

Again we read dat de Hebrew children was cast into de firy furnace, and dat air always look'd like a pig story too, for they would have been purnt up; put it ish all plain to my mint now, for they was shust cast close py or near to de firy furnace. O, I vas so glad I vas here to-night!

"And den, Mister Breacher, it ish said dat Jonah was cast into de sea and into de whale's pelly. Now I nefer could pelief dot. It seems like a pig fish story, put it ish all plain to my mint now, he vas not taken into the whale's pelly at all, put shust shumped onto his pack and rode ashore. O, I vash so glad I vash here to-night!

"And now, Mister Breacher, if you will shust explain two more bassages of Scripture I shall pe, O, happy that I vas here to-night! One of them is vere it saish de vicked shall pe cast into a lake dat purns with fire and primstone alvays. O, Mister Breacher, shall I pe cast into that lake, if I am vicked, or shust close py or near to, shust near enough to pe comfortable? O, I hopes you tell me I shall pe cast shust py a good vay off, and I vill pe so glad I vas here to-night. The other bassage is that which saish plessed are dey who do dese commandments, dat dey may have right to the tree of life and enter through the gates into the city. O! tell me I shall get into the city and not shust close py or near to, shust near enough to see vat I have lost, and I shall pe so glad I vas here to-night."

GUM ARABIC.—The most familiar objects are those we often the least understand, and probably few pause to ask the question: "What is gum arabic and whence comes it?" In Morocco, about the middle of November, (that is after the rainy season) a gummy juice exudes spontaneously from the trunk and branches of the acacia. It gradually thickens in the furrow down which it runs, and assumes the form of oval and round drops about the size of a pigeon's egg, of different colors, as it comes from the red or white gum tree. About the middle of December, the Moors encamp on the border of the forest, and the harvest lasts a full month. The gum is packed in large leather sacks and transported on the backs of camels and bullocks to seaports for shipment. The harvest season is one of great rejoicing, and the people for the time being almost live on the gum, which is nutritious and fattening.

A MAN writing poetically of the weather says: "The back bone of winter is broken, but the tail wags yet occasionally."